

OSF x ANDELA HACKATHON 2026 · BUILD FOR AFRICA, TAKE IT TO KENYA



VeriVoice

Verify. Understand. Act.

A multilingual civic information assistant that helps Kenyans check the voice notes, messages, and screenshots they receive, before they act on them or share them.

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Amata · Andela Learning Community · September 2026

THE PROBLEM

The information arrives as a voice note.

A rumour about school fees. A fake tender. A distorted quote from a county budget. By the time it reaches a market trader in Gikomba, it is spoken text in Sheng, not an article with a URL.

Voice-first

WhatsApp voice notes are the dominant format in Kenyan group chats. There is no link to check and no text to paste.

Vernacular

Claims circulate in Sheng and Kiswahili. Fact-checking sites are text-first and English-first.

Costly

Misinformation has driven mob action, depressed vaccine uptake, and buried real corruption behind noise.

WHO IT IS FOR

Verification should not be a **privilege** of the well-informed.

VeriVoice is built for the people most exposed to harmful information and least equipped to challenge it:

Market traders acting on forwarded price notices

Parents reacting to school fee rumours

Matatu crews sharing route and security alerts

Community groups coordinating around county budgets

THE USER MOMENT

Someone sends you a voice note. You have 30 seconds and 20MB of data. Do you believe it, ignore it, or forward it?

VeriVoice gives that decision a fourth option: **check it.**

THE SOLUTION

An assistant that checks what **you** received.

Submit information exactly as it reached you. VeriVoice verifies it, explains the result in your language, and gives you something safe to share back.

Receive → Understand → Verify → Explain → Share



Voice note

Speak or upload. No typing needed.



Text

Paste the message as it was forwarded.



Screenshot

Photograph the screen you saw it on.

HOW IT WORKS

One pipeline, **five stages**

1

Transcription & OCR

Audio becomes text; text inside screenshots is read. Sheng and Kiswahili are understood, not rejected.

2

Claim extraction

The message is broken into the specific claims a person might act on.

3

Evidence retrieval

Each claim is checked against web sources: official circulars, news, fact-checks.

4

AI reconciliation

Evidence is weighed against the claim. Confidence and gaps are recorded, never hidden.

5

Explanation & share

Plain language, real sources, clear next steps, and a card to share back to the group chat.

An assistant, **never an oracle.**

VeriVoice never claims the authority to declare truth. Every verdict shows its evidence, its confidence, and its limits.

Verdicts, not decrees Supported, Disputed, Misleading, or Unverified

Sources you can open Every claim links to its evidence

Honest confidence High, medium, or low, and why

What we do not know Stated in plain words

Next steps Real institutions, real hotlines, real options

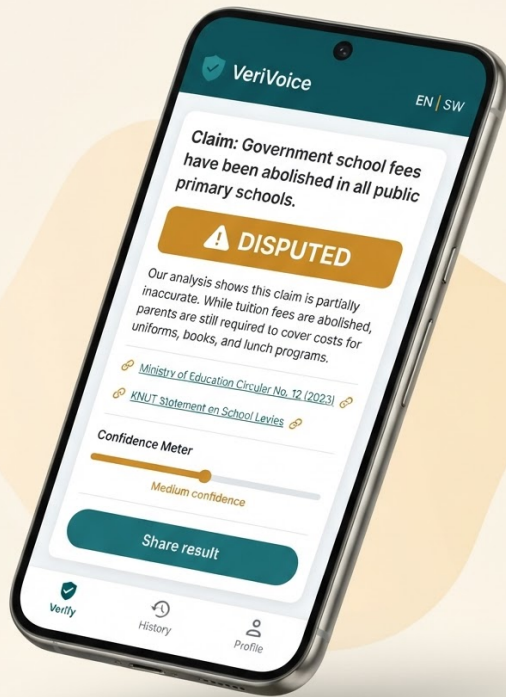
WHEN EVIDENCE IS THIN

"Hakuna ushahidi wa kutosha.
Usiendelee kusambaza hadi
uthibitishwe."

"There is not enough evidence. Do not spread it until it is confirmed."

THE VERDICT CARD

One card per claim, **everything a decision needs**



1. **The claim**, restated simply
2. **The verdict**, in a badge you can read at arm's length
3. **The evidence**, with named sources
4. **Confidence**, and what we do not know
5. **Next steps**, including who to confirm with
6. **A share card**, so the correction travels as far as the rumour

EN

Kiswahili

Sheng-friendly input

BUILT FOR REAL CONDITIONS

Designed for how Kenya **actually** connects

Low bandwidth

Text-first, lightweight responses.
Audio processed once, server-side.
Share cards are a few lines, not a video.

Accessibility

Voice-first input means no typing.
Large text and plain language
serve low-literacy users.

Multilingual

English and Kiswahili output,
Sheng tolerated generously.
People do not switch registers to
verify a rumour.

Privacy

No account needed. Recordings
and screenshots are processed,
not retained. Nothing leaves your
phone without your action.

Local relevance

Next steps name Kenyan
institutions and hotlines, not
generic "contact the authorities".

Safety routing

Claims touching violence or public
health route to established
reporting and support pathways.

WHY IT MATTERS

Shifting the power to judge **to communities themselves**

OSF's Transformative Peace in Africa initiative is about moving power into the hands of communities. VeriVoice does that for information: verification becomes a capability people perform themselves, not a service performed about them.

Cross-track fit. Reducing friction between communities (Stability & Social Cohesion), helping people scrutinize official decisions (Transparency &

Today: one user checks one claim

A parent catches a fake fee notice before paying a bribe.

Tomorrow: a community checks itself

Radio call-in segments, shared claim pages, verify-by-forward on WhatsApp.

Eventually: a public good

Partnerships with community radio, CSOs, and county information desks.

ROADMAP

From invention sprint to **everyday habit**

Now (PoC): full core loop. Voice, text, and screenshot in; verdicts, sources, and next steps out.

Next: WhatsApp integration. Verify by forwarding to a VeriVoice number. No new app to install.

Then: community radio call-in verification segments and a public claim-check page.

Later: offline-tolerant caching of frequently checked claims; expansion to more countries and languages.

SEE IT WORK

Live demo

Try it with your own voice note, message, or screenshot.

Source code

github.com/Angelcoder87/Verivoice

VeriVoice · Receive → Understand → Verify → Explain → Share

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